4 ChatGPT Prompts to Help You Plan for an Aging Parent

Copy-and-paste prompts to write down how your parent is doing today, count the help already in place, get ready for the care conversation, and see what you still don't know.

Where you are

Mom still lives at home and manages most things herself. You have noticed a few changes, nobody has talked about what she would want if she needed more help, and you are not sure what to look at first.

This guide gives you four ChatGPT prompts to organize what you already know and to see what you don't know yet. It is preparation, not an assessment. Use only information you have permission to share, with names removed. The AI organizes and drafts; it does not diagnose, assess safety, explain coverage rules, or decide. Bring clinical questions to a clinician and coverage questions to the facility or the agency that runs the program, and call emergency services for an emergency.

What you'll have at the end

You have a dated picture of how Mom is doing today, a list of the help she already gets, questions ready for a conversation with her, and a short list of what you still need to find out.

A one-page list: How Mom is doing today, The help already in place, What she has told us she wants, What we don't know, and Questions to ask, with who to ask.

Before you start

- A few notes on how Mom has been doing lately, and any changes you have noticed during the past year.
- A rough idea of who helps her now, and with what.
- A quiet time to talk with her. You don't need all three to begin.

PROMPT 1

Write down how Mom is doing today

WHY THIS MATTERS

Changes in mobility, memory, health, and independence often develop gradually. A dated description of today gives you something to compare against later, so you are not relying on memory.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Your notes on an ordinary week, and any changes you have noticed during the past year.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> I'm writing down how my mother is doing so our family has something to compare against later. Nothing urgent is happening. Here are my notes on an ordinary week and the changes I've noticed during the past year:

> [PASTE YOUR NOTES]
>
> Using only what I've written, organize it under these headings: HEALTH, MEMORY, GETTING AROUND, EVERYDAY ACTIVITIES, MEDICATIONS, MEALS, DRIVING AND TRANSPORTATION, HOUSEHOLD AND MONEY. Under each, separate WHAT I OBSERVED from WHAT I'M WORRIED ABOUT. Where I said nothing, write NOT NOTED. Do not tell me whether anything is normal for her age, and do not suggest a diagnosis or any change to her medications.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

A snapshot with the blanks showing, and your worries kept apart from what you actually saw.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Put today's date at the top and save it where you'll find it again.

PROMPT 2

Count the help that's already in place

WHY THIS MATTERS

Help tends to grow a little at a time: a ride to an appointment, a hand with the bills, a neighbor who checks in. Seeing it all in one list shows how Mom is really managing.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

A list of everyone who helps Mom, what they do, and roughly when it started.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is everyone who helps my mother, what they do, and roughly when each thing started:
>
> [PASTE YOUR LIST]
>
> Make a simple table: who helps, what they help with, how often, and when it started. Then list the everyday tasks I haven't mentioned at all, as questions for me to answer by asking or observing. Don't answer them yourself, and don't treat a task nobody helps with as a sign that something is wrong.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Help you weren't counting, and tasks you haven't thought about yet.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Ask the people on the list whether the table matches what they actually do.

PROMPT 3

Get ready for the care conversation

WHY THIS MATTERS

Nobody can plan around Mom's wishes until someone asks her. A few open questions, prepared ahead, make the conversation easier to begin and easier to remember afterward.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

What you already know about Mom's preferences, and who she would want in the conversation.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Help me prepare for a conversation with my mother about her future care preferences. Here is what I already know about what she wants, and who she would want involved:
>
> [PASTE YOUR NOTES]
>
> Write ten open questions I can ask her, covering where she would prefer to receive care, how important remaining at home is to her, what she expects from family, and who she wants involved in decisions. Keep the questions respectful and unhurried, and leave room for her answers in her own words. Do not suggest what she should choose.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Questions that invite her to talk, not ones that steer her to an answer.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Have the conversation, and write down what she says in her own words.

PROMPT 4

Put it on one page

WHY THIS MATTERS

One page lets the family start from the same place, and it shows what is still open. Some of those open questions belong to her care providers or another professional, not to the family and not to an AI.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Everything from the first three prompts, including what Mom told you.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is everything I've gathered about my mother:
>
> [PASTE EVERYTHING FROM PROMPTS 1 TO 3]
>
> Give me one page with five headings: HOW MOM IS DOING TODAY, THE HELP ALREADY IN PLACE, WHAT SHE HAS TOLD US SHE WANTS, WHAT WE DON'T KNOW, and QUESTIONS TO ASK. Under the last heading, mark each question with who should answer it: Mom, family, her doctor, a pharmacist, a Medicaid planner, or not sure. Do not predict how her needs will change, do not say whether she is safe at home, and do not estimate future costs.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

One page you could share with a sibling and have them understand where things stand.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Keep the page. It's the start of the next step below.

Turn your notes into a profile

You've written down what you know and what you still want to ask. The care interview walks you through the questions that fill those gaps and produces a Family Care Profile you can bring to your Medicaid planner.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›